



The Paralympic Games



The Paralympic Games are an **international sports competition** for disabled athletes held every four years. There are both Summer and Winter Paralympics.



Origins

In 1948, Sir Ludwig Guttmann organized a sports competition at a hospital in England for soldiers who had suffered injuries while fighting during **World War II**. Four years later, competitors from the Netherlands joined the Games and the Paralympic movement was born.



Most of the sports played at the Paralympics are the same as the ones at the Olympics. But a few, such as "goalball" and "boccia," are unique to the Paralympics.